

Aakarsh Bengani

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Education

University of California, Berkeley

2021–2025

Bachelor's in Data Science

Coursework: Computer Architecture, Linear Algebra, Discrete Mathematics, Probability Theory, Cognitive Neuroscience, Structure and Interpretation of Computer Programs, Computational Biology, Molecular Biology, Data Structures, Computer Security, Inference and Decision Making, Game Theory, Microeconomics

Activities: Berkeley AI Safety Initiative, Underwater Robotics Club, Climbing and Outdoor Society

Recent Experience

Center For AI Safety — AI Research

2025–26 | San Francisco

I built the agent automation layer for our editorial and research teams. Conducted red-teaming our cluster and shipping patches. I built a Coursera course on foundational AI security and governance, curated data for the Humanity's Last Exam benchmark (one of the most used benchmarks by top AI Labs).

Silver Beach Institute — Co-founder

2024–25 (currently on pause)

We created a new institution for funding breakthrough biology research in India, emphasizing open science and real-time progress updates. Our goal was to provide each scientist a \$35K annual stipend plus a dedicated lab budget, and we partnered with advisors from MIT, the University of Washington, and Fred Hutchinson Cancer Center.

Berkeley AI Safety Student Initiative — Co-founder

2023–2025

I built and grew Berkeley's AI Safety community to 300+ students. I secured a \$250K Open Philanthropy grant and launched our alignment-engineering & ML Interpretability course under Professor Stuart Russell. We also hosted 10+ events for 500+ attendees total. I managed a technical ML security RFP and granted 10+ teams of undergrads and independent researchers.

Past Experience

Open Web Collective — Engineering Intern

2023 | New York

I analyzed performance-to-compute ratios across leading LLMs (GPT-3, PaLM, Chinchilla) to identify scaling efficiency patterns. I distilled these findings to evaluate AGI-focused projects and helped on Anthropic's Series B funding by preparing investment memos and internal benchmarks to measure robustness and transparency for earlier versions of Claude models.

Composer — Intern

2022 | San Francisco

Composer is a retail-investing platform that automates options-hedging. They built a web-based simulation dashboard so users could design, backtest, and refine strategies like volatility collars and calendar spreads—and we saw over \$5M in notional trade volume during our pilot. I helped them expand their user base to the Bay area.

RetOpto & PwC Research — Founder & Internship

2021–2022

I began at PwC India researching reverse logistics systems for e-commerce shops in the Indian market, publishing my findings in PwC Research Insights. As a follow-up on my report, I built RetOpto—an inventory optimization platform that is used by 250+ brick-and-mortar retailers in India. We won the University of Michigan Startup Incubator competition.

On the side

- Participated on the controls team for the [RoboSub](#) autonomous underwater vehicle competition. We won 2nd prize overall.
- [rewardcap](#): A toy model reward-composition primitive that makes RL post-training robust.
- Building [Baseplate](#) (in progress), a programmable cloud lab where researchers submit wet-lab protocols as code and our robots run them - starting with plasmid construction and cell-based screening.
- Head Boy at my high school; captain of the state soccer team in Uttar Pradesh, India.